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24 MAR 2025
EXAMINATIONS & REGISTRATION

University of Colombo, Sri Lanka

University of Colombo School of Computing

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION SYSTEMS

First Year Examination - Semester II - UCSC AY21 [held in March/ April 2025]

IS1213 - Organizational Behaviour

(Two (2) Hours)

Answer ALL questions

Number of Pages = 12 Number of Questions = 4

To be completed by the candidate

Index Number: | | | | | | | | |

Important Instructions to candidates:

I. Students should answer in the medium of English language only using the space provided in this question paper.

II. Note that questions appear on both sides of the paper. If a page or a part of this question paper is not printed, please inform the supervisor immediately.

III. Write your index number CLEARLY on each and every page of this Question paper.

IV. This paper consists of 4 questions in 12 pages (including the Cover Page).

V. Answer ALL questions.

VI. Calculators and any electronic device capable of storing and retrieving text including electronic dictionaries, smart watches and mobile phones are not allowed.

VII. Do not tear off any part of this answer book. Under no circumstances may this book, used or unused, be removed from the Examination Hall by a candidate

To be completed by the examiners

1	
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Question 1

Organisations increasingly recognize the value of diversity and the need to prevent discrimination in the workplace. Many IT organisations have implemented anti-discriminatory policies to foster an inclusive environment.

(a) Define workplace diversity and list **three (3)** key factors that highlight the importance of workplace diversity in organisational behavior.

[05 marks]

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(b) Write down **three (3)** key ways in which anti-discriminatory policies influence employee behavior and organisational culture in IT organisations.

[06 marks]

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(c) You have been assigned to lead a new project team in a software company. The team consists of members with diverse personality traits. Using either the Big Five Personality Model or the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI), answer the following:

Briefly explain how you can understand your team members' personalities using one of the above models. You can use any **three (3)** personality traits.

[06 marks]

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(d) Provide **two (2)** examples of how different personality traits might influence teamwork, communication, and decision-making.

[08 marks]

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Question 2

(a) In a software development team, misunderstandings and incorrect judgments about team members' abilities and intentions can impact teamwork and decision-making.

Identify and explain two (2) common perceptual errors that might occur in a team setting within an IT organisation.

[06 marks]

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(b) Using Attribution Theory, analyse how perceptual errors can affect teamwork and decision-making. In your answer, explain how internal and external attributions may lead to misjudgments about a team member's performance or behaviour.

[08 marks]

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(c) Effective communication is essential for workplace success, but several barriers can hinder the flow of information between employees.

List **five (5)** common barriers that can impact effective communication in a workplace.

[05 marks]

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(d) Effective communication is essential for smooth operations within an organisation. Organisations use different communication flows to share information and coordinate tasks.

Provide **one (1)** workplace example for each of the following types of communication in an organisational context:

1. Upward Communication
2. Downward Communication
3. Lateral Communication

[06 marks]

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Question 3

Emma is a software developer at Tech Solutions Inc., a mid-sized IT organisation. She has been with the company for three years and has consistently delivered high-quality work. Recently, Emma has been feeling demotivated and less engaged with her tasks. She feels that her efforts are not being recognised and that her salary is not comparable to that of her peers in similar positions and with similar performance both within her company and at other companies. Moreover, there have been changes in the company's management, leading to less clarity in communication and expectations.

(a) Using Herzberg's Two-Factor Model, identify and explain the possible hygiene factors and motivators that could be affecting Emma's motivation. You need to explain hygiene factors and motivators separately.

[10 marks]

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(b) Employee retention has become increasingly challenging in today's workplace. Considering Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, it is often debated whether hygiene factors or motivators play a greater role in retaining employees. Identify and list **five (5)** key factors that organisations should focus on to improve the retention of the new generation of employees.

[05 marks]

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(c) Using Adams' Equity Theory, analyse how Emma's perception of equity might be influencing her motivation. Discuss the potential outcomes of perceived inequity and suggest strategies the company could use to achieve a sense of equity for Emma.

[10 marks]

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Question 4

(a) The Five-Stage Group Development Model explains the stages a group goes through as it develops and becomes more cohesive. List the five (5) stages of the Group Development Model.

[05 marks]

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(b) Work Teams and Work Groups are commonly used in today's workplace. List **three (3)** key differences between Work Teams and Work Groups.

[06 marks]

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(c) Emotional Intelligence (EI) is critical for effective leadership and teamwork in organisations. Some key elements of Emotional Intelligence are centered around understanding self, working with others and empathy. Briefly explain each of the **five (5)** elements of Emotional Intelligence (including empathy).

[10 marks]

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(d) List **four (4)** key differences between emotions and moods.

[04 marks]

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